

Dune species guides

Coastal systems are highly specialised ecosystems, and need careful planning to restore them.

Please refer to the following resources for guidance:

- For general coastal restoration: [Coastal Restoration Trust of New Zealand](#)
- Restoration planting on the coast in the [Foxton Ecological District](#)

How to use the plant species guides:

1. You will need to work out what parts of your coastal area are considered to be front, middle and rear dune areas. Features like dune slacks or exposed dune faces differ widely in available moisture and wind and salt exposure – all of which will affect what plants will survive.
2. The following pages have some suggestions for some suitable species at coastal sites in our region, but you should decide what is appropriate based on local conditions.
3. Remember that coastal ecosystems are typically harsh environments. Plants can struggle to establish, and growth can be slow. You may need to experiment with what survives at your particular site.

Coastal sand dunes – front dune

Common species in a native ecosystem:



pīngao



kōwhangatara

Suitable plants:



Pīngao
Ficinia spiralis



Kōwhangatara | spinifex
Spinifex sericeus



Coastal sand dunes – middle dune

Common species in a native ecosystem:



wiwi



tātaraheke



harakeke



pōhuehue



toetoe



tauhinu

Suitable plants:



Toetoe
Austroderia toetoe



Speckled sedge
Carex testacea



Tātaraheke | sand coprosma
Coprosma acerosa



Wiwi | knobby club rush
Ficinia nodosa



Scrub pōhuehue | wire vine
Muehlenbeckia complexa



Tauhinu
Ozothamnus leptophyllus



Harakeke | flax
Phormium tenax



Coastal sand dunes – rear dune

Common species in a native ecosystem:



kānuka



harakeke



tī kōuka



karamū



akeake



ngaio

Suitable plants:



Karamū
Coprosma robusta



Kānuka
Kunzea robusta



Tī kōuka | cabbage tree
Cordyline australis



Ngaio
*Myoporum laetum**



Akeake
*Dodonaea viscosa**



Harakeke, wharariki | flax
Phormium tenax
Phormium cookianum subsp. *hookeri*

*take extra care with species; cultivars and a weed Tasmanian species are sometimes accidentally sold

